Core 01 | Therapist guide only

Direction and goals: Therapist guide

First unit: Choosing a personal direction and a shared action plan.

Purpose of this unit

Help the client express what matters, choose a noticeable change in daily life and plan a small attempt to learn from. All therapy goals need not be set in one meeting.

Before use

Professional assessment and agreement on the working framework take place as needed. This kit is not a diagnostic form, full informed consent or risk assessment. Return to an introductory conversation if the focus is still unclear.

Suggested sequence for working together

This is an order for using the materials, not a required schedule or number of meetings.

1. Opening, SES-S01: Listen to the current situation, review previous attempts if any, and choose a focus together. At a first meeting, skip reviewing previous practice.

2. Goals, INT-I04: Start with what matters to the client and define a describable change. Explore the current situation and a personal sign of progress.

3. Practice, CORE-01-P: Choose a small action, suitable time and context, support and an alternative if difficulties arise. Distinguish planning from recording after the attempt.

4. Summary, SES-S02: Gather learning, invite feedback and check that the next steps are understood and suitable. There is no need to copy the entire action plan again.

Noticeable change instead of a demand to control feelings

Make room for wanting to feel better, then explore what participation or action in life would matter. Wording such as never worrying is not a condition for success or completing the sheet.

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Age adaptations and choosing wording

First unit: Choosing a personal direction and a shared action plan.

Choosing a version

Catalog ages are organizational categories. Choose wording by development, reading ability, needs and preferences. Reading aloud and writing together are possible without turning the sheet into a test.

Group	Points for the work
Children	One question at a time, a concrete example, one goal and a short step. Preserve the child's voice and coordinate parent involvement as needed.
Adolescents	Explore what matters to the adolescent. Offer choice, room for feedback and clear agreements about sharing information and support.
Adults	Connect the goal with functioning and circumstances. Choose an action within the person's influence and plan time, support and adaptations.
Older adults	Use adult language and preserve choice and independence. Do not assume reduced ability. Adapt font size, pace or help according to need and preference.

Fictional examples of choosing a step

These examples illustrate wording only. They are not recommended tasks for a particular client.

1. Child: Being ready for school matters to me. A step to explore together: prepare one notebook at a chosen time, with a reminder the child agreed to.

2. Adolescent: I want to start tasks without putting everything off. A possible step to discuss: choose one task and plan only how to begin it.

3. Adult: Staying connected matters to me. A possible step to discuss: choose a suitable time for brief contact with someone close.

4. Older adult: Returning to a meaningful activity matters to me. A possible step to discuss: explore a desired activity and conditions for comfortable participation.

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Barriers, choice and learning

First unit: Choosing a personal direction and a shared action plan.

If choosing a goal is difficult

Start by describing a more desirable day, a burdensome area or something the client wants to preserve. The goal may remain open and be revisited; there is no need to manufacture agreement.

If someone else chose the goal

Distinguish a parent's, institution's or relative's concerns from the client's wishes. Seek common ground without erasing the client's position. Agree on a support person's involvement according to circumstances and applicable professional rules.

If the practice was not completed

Explore whether the action was clear, desired and possible, and what conditions or barriers existed. Reduce the step, change the context or choose another focus. Do not treat sheet completion as a measure of cooperation or therapeutic success.

If a difficulty needs another response

Return to assessment and professional judgment. The form does not provide automatic decisions about referral, diagnosis or safety, and must not replace appropriate assessment.

Brief questions to review the plan

For discussion, without a score or cutoff:

1. Does the goal reflect something important to the client, and can it be changed later?

2. Can we describe the step and what we will try to observe or learn?

3. Is the action within the person's influence, appropriate and safe in the circumstances?

4. Have barriers, support and possible adaptations been discussed?

5. Does the client want and feel able to explain the choice in their own words, and when will we review it?

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Professional review and sources

First unit: Choosing a personal direction and a shared action plan.

Separating therapist and client materials

The guide is for the therapist only. Each age packet includes only the four sheets for joint completion or planned follow-up. Decide which sheet is suitable to provide, without sharing private professional notes.

Status of the kit

The wording was written for Mindful Path development using general CBT principles. No existing form was copied or translated. The kit has not yet undergone independent clinical review or validation and is not diagnostic. Producing the file does not approve clinical use or commercial distribution.

Record of a future professional review

Reviewer's name and relevant qualifications; date and version reviewed

Age versions reviewed and points needing correction

Review clarity, age suitability, writing burden, accessibility and limits on sharing

General sources for further reading

Beck Institute Cares: What Are CBT Sessions Like?
Principles of a shared agenda, goals, action planning and monitoring; not a source for copying a form.
https://cares.beckinstitute.org/about-cbt/what-are-sessions-like/

NICE NG197: Shared decision making
Context for choice, preferences, shared understanding and reviewing decisions.
https://www.nice.org.uk/guidance/ng197/chapter/recommendations

NICE NG134: Recommendations
Principles for considering development and needs; the guideline concerns depression and does not validate this kit.
https://www.nice.org.uk/guidance/ng134/chapter/recommendations

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